FIVE TYPES OF CONTEXT CLUES

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the box. For each sentence, circle the meaning of the word in capitals, then write which type of clue helped you (D, S, A, E or I).

THE FIVE CLUE TYPES

D Definition: the meaning is given in the sentence. "A habitat, the place where an animal lives, can be a forest or a pond."

S Synonym: a word with the same meaning is nearby. "She was jubilant, absolutely delighted, when she won."

A Antonym: a word with the opposite meaning is nearby. "Unlike his tidy sister, Max was slovenly."

E Example: examples show what the word means. "Reptiles, such as snakes, lizards and turtles, are cold-blooded."

I Inference: you work it out from the whole sentence. "After running the marathon, Dev was so famished he ate three dinners."

CIRCLE THE MEANING, THEN WRITE THE CLUE TYPE

1. The ARID desert had not seen rain for eleven months. (clue type: ____)
   a) very dry **b) sandy** **c) cold**
2. Ravi was RELUCTANT, or unwilling, to leave the party. (clue type: ____)
   a) excited **b) unwilling** **c) late**
3. Unlike the FRIGID water in the lake, the pool was pleasantly warm. (clue type: ____)
   a) deep **b) very cold** **c) clear**
4. CITRUS fruits, such as oranges, lemons and limes, are full of vitamin C. (clue type: ____)
   a) sweet fruits **b) a family of sharp-tasting fruits** **c) vegetables**
5. The vase is FRAGILE, so carry it with both hands and do not run. (clue type: ____)
   a) heavy **b) easily broken** **c) expensive**
6. An OMNIVORE is an animal that eats both plants and meat. (clue type: ____)
   a) a plant-eater **b) an animal that eats plants and meat** **c) a hunter**
7. Grandad was DROWSY after lunch and soon fell asleep in his chair. (clue type: ____)
   a) sleepy **b) hungry** **c) angry**
8. The old house was VACANT; nobody had lived there for years. (clue type: ____)
   a) haunted **b) empty** **c) enormous**
9. Mia is usually TIMID, but her brother is bold and loud. (clue type: ____)
   a) shy **b) brave** **c) funny**
10. The ANCIENT coin, minted two thousand years ago, was worn smooth. (clue type: ____)
    a) golden **b) very old** **c) valuable**

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FIVE TYPES OF CONTEXT CLUES ANSWER KEY

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

CIRCLE THE MEANING, THEN WRITE THE CLUE TYPE

1. a) very dry 2. b) unwilling 3. b) very cold 4. b) a family of sharp-tasting fruits 5. b) easily broken 6. b) an animal that eats plants and meat 7. a) sleepy 8. b) empty 9. a) shy 10. b) very old

Clue types: 1 I, 2 D (or S), 3 A, 4 E, 5 I, 6 D, 7 I, 8 D, 9 A, 10 D (or I).

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